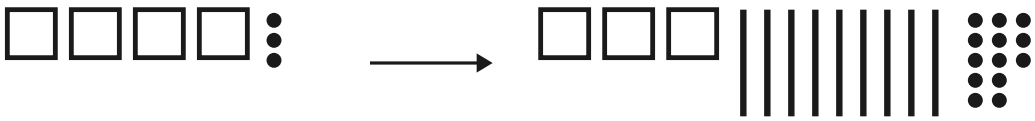
Subtracting Across Zeros

No tens to break? Think of the number as tens and ones.

403 – 157: 3 – 7? Break a ten. But there are 0 tens!



4 hundreds, 3 ones

Break a hundred into 10 tens, then a ten into 10 ones.

The shortcut: 403 is 40 tens and 3 ones

403 = 40 tens + 3 ones

403 = 39 tens + 13 ones

Take 1 ten from the 40 tens. Now there are 39 tens and 13 ones. One break!

Now subtract: 157 is 15 tens and 7 ones

tens	39 – 15 = 24 tens
ones	13 – 7 = 6
total	240 + 6 = 246

Check by adding:

246 + 157 = 403

Your turn!

302 – 145 = 157

break	302 = 29 tens + 12 ones
tens	29 – 14 = 15
ones	12 – 5 = 7
total	150 + 7 = 157

For teachers

Goal: subtract when the top number has zeros (2.NBT.7). Say “403 is 40 tens and 3 ones,” then break one ten: 39 tens and 13 ones. Watch for 0 – 7 = 7 (the 0 can’t give). Check every answer by adding.

Subtracting Across Zeros: Practice

Think of the top number as tens and ones. Break once.

Part 1 Tens and ones Write it as tens and ones, then break one ten.

1) 403 = 40 tens + 3 ones
403 = 39 tens + 13 ones

2) 702 = 70 tens + 2 ones
702 = 69 tens + 12 ones

3) 305 = 30 tens + 5 ones
305 = 29 tens + 15 ones

4) 600 = 60 tens + 0 ones
600 = 59 tens + 10 ones

5) 801 = 80 tens + 1 ones
801 = 79 tens + 11 ones

6) 506 = 50 tens + 6 ones
506 = 49 tens + 16 ones

7) 900 = 90 tens + 0 ones
900 = 89 tens + 10 ones

8) 204 = 20 tens + 4 ones
204 = 19 tens + 14 ones

Part 2 Break, then subtract The break row is done for you.

9) 402 − 135 = 267

break	402 = 39 tens + 12 ones
tens	39 − 13 = 26
ones	12 − 5 = 7
total	260 + 7 = 267

10) 703 − 248 = 455

break	703 = 69 tens + 13 ones
tens	69 − 24 = 45
ones	13 − 8 = 5
total	450 + 5 = 455

Subtracting Across Zeros: Practice (continued)

Part 2 Break, then subtract (continued)

11) **500 − 164 = 336**

break	500 = 49 tens + 10 ones
tens	49 − 16 = 33
ones	10 − 4 = 6
total	330 + 6 = 336

12) **610 − 253 = 357**

break	610 = 60 tens + 10 ones
tens	60 − 25 = 35
ones	10 − 3 = 7
total	350 + 7 = 357

Part 3 Fill in every box

13) **804 − 376 = 428**

break	804 = 79 tens + 14 ones
tens	79 − 37 = 42
ones	14 − 6 = 8
total	420 + 8 = 428

14) **301 − 127 = 174**

break	301 = 29 tens + 11 ones
tens	29 − 12 = 17
ones	11 − 7 = 4
total	170 + 4 = 174

15) **900 − 465 = 435**

break	900 = 89 tens + 10 ones
tens	89 − 46 = 43
ones	10 − 5 = 5
total	430 + 5 = 435

16) **520 − 148 = 372**

break	520 = 51 tens + 10 ones
tens	51 − 14 = 37
ones	10 − 8 = 2
total	370 + 2 = 372

Subtracting Across Zeros: Practice (continued)

Part 4 Stack it Cross out the tens, write the new tens and ones on top, then subtract.

17)

	hundreds	tens	ones
	4	9	13
	~~5~~	~~0~~	~~3~~
−	2	7	6
	2	2	7

18)

	hundreds	tens	ones
	3	9	10
	~~4~~	~~0~~	~~0~~
−	2	1	8
	1	8	2

19)

	hundreds	tens	ones
	6	12	10
	~~7~~	~~3~~	~~0~~
−	3	6	4
	3	6	6

20)

	hundreds	tens	ones
	8	9	11
	~~9~~	~~0~~	~~1~~
−	4	5	2
	4	4	9

Part 5 Zero in the tens No help this time.

21)

	3	9	13
	~~4~~	~~0~~	~~3~~
−	1	5	7
	2	4	6

22)

	5	9	15
	~~6~~	~~0~~	~~5~~
−	2	3	8
	3	6	7

23)

	7	9	12
	~~8~~	~~0~~	~~2~~
−	4	6	5
	3	3	7

24)

	6	9	14
	~~7~~	~~0~~	~~4~~
−	3	2	9
	3	7	5

25)

	4	9	11
	~~5~~	~~0~~	~~1~~
−	2	8	6
	2	1	5

26)

	8	9	16
	~~9~~	~~0~~	~~6~~
−	5	4	7
	3	5	9

27)

	2	9	18
	~~3~~	~~0~~	~~8~~
−	1	5	9
	1	4	9

28)

	1	9	17
	~~2~~	~~0~~	~~7~~
−	1	4	8
		5	9

Part 6 Zero in the ones No help this time.

Subtracting Across Zeros: Practice (continued)

Part 6 Zero in the ones (continued)

29)

	4	10	10
	~~5~~	~~1~~	~~0~~
−	2	3	4
	2	7	6

30)

	6	11	10
	~~7~~	~~2~~	~~0~~
−	3	8	5
	3	3	5

31)

	5	13	10
	~~6~~	~~4~~	~~0~~
−	1	7	2
	4	6	8

32)

	7	12	10
	~~8~~	~~3~~	~~0~~
−	4	5	6
	3	7	4

33)

	3	14	10
	~~4~~	~~5~~	~~0~~
−	1	8	7
	2	6	3

34)

	8	10	10
	~~9~~	~~1~~	~~0~~
−	5	3	8
	3	7	2

35)

	2	16	10
	~~3~~	~~7~~	~~0~~
−	1	9	4
	1	7	6

36)

	1	15	10
	~~2~~	~~6~~	~~0~~
−	1	7	5
		8	5

Part 7 Two zeros No help this time.

37)

	2	9	10
	~~3~~	~~0~~	~~0~~
−	1	2	8
	1	7	2

38)

	4	9	10
	~~5~~	~~0~~	~~0~~
−	2	4	6
	2	5	4

39)

	6	9	10
	~~7~~	~~0~~	~~0~~
−	3	5	1
	3	4	9

40)

	3	9	10
	~~4~~	~~0~~	~~0~~
−	1	6	3
	2	3	7

Subtracting Across Zeros: Practice (continued)

Part 7 Two zeros (continued)

41)

	7	9	10
	~~8~~	~~0~~	~~0~~
−	4	7	2
	3	2	8

42)

	5	9	10
	~~6~~	~~0~~	~~0~~
−	2	8	9
	3	1	1

43)

	8	9	10
	~~9~~	~~0~~	~~0~~
−	5	3	7
	3	6	3

44)

	1	9	10
	~~2~~	~~0~~	~~0~~
−	1	4	6
		5	4

Part 8 Mixed Break only when you need to.

45)

	6	0	5
−	3	0	2
	3	0	3

46)

	7	9	13
	~~8~~	~~0~~	~~3~~
−	2	6	7
	5	3	6

47)

		3	10
	5	~~4~~	~~0~~
−	3	1	5
	2	2	5

48)

	6	9	10
	~~7~~	~~0~~	~~0~~
−	4	2	5
	2	7	5

49)

	3	9	16
	~~4~~	~~0~~	~~6~~
−	1	3	8
	2	6	8

50)

	8	16	
	~~9~~	~~6~~	0
−	5	8	0
	3	8	0

51)

	2	9	12
	~~3~~	~~0~~	~~2~~
−	1	8	5
	1	1	7

52)

		4	10
	8	~~5~~	~~0~~
−	6	2	4
	2	2	6

Part 9 Check by adding No help this time. Do you get the top number back?

53) 246 + 157 = 403

54) 177 + 128 = 305

55) 365 + 245 = 610

Subtracting Across Zeros: Practice (continued)

Part 9 Check by adding (continued)

56) 226 + 274 = 500

57) 318 + 282 = 600

58) 459 + 141 = 600

Part 10 More across zeros

59) 300 − 251 = 49

60) 807 − 676 = 131

61) 401 − 385 = 16

62) 400 − 203 = 197

63) 805 − 771 = 34

64) 400 − 264 = 136

65) 900 − 205 = 695

66) 500 − 271 = 229

67) 900 − 564 = 336

68) 700 − 675 = 25

69) 500 − 177 = 323

70) 600 − 583 = 17

Subtracting Across Zeros: Practice (continued)

Part 10 More across zeros (continued)

71) 800 − 429 = 371

72) 600 − 264 = 336

73) 407 − 376 = 31

74) 300 − 185 = 115

75) 400 − 314 = 86

76) 300 − 132 = 168

77) 200 − 139 = 61

78) 300 − 166 = 134

79) 800 − 612 = 188

80) 900 − 151 = 749

81) 200 − 179 = 21

82) 300 − 270 = 30

83) 603 − 118 = 485

84) 900 − 136 = 764

Subtracting Across Zeros: Practice (continued)

Part 10 More across zeros (continued)

85) 600 − 313 = 287

86) 700 − 398 = 302

87) 702 − 492 = 210

88) 203 − 174 = 29

89) 408 − 162 = 246

90) 300 − 118 = 182

91) 600 − 255 = 345

92) 400 − 338 = 62

93) 204 − 166 = 38

94) 200 − 110 = 90

Part 11 Remember? Problems from earlier packets.

95) 65¢ + 25¢ = 90¢

96) half past 7 = 7:30

97) 352 + 216 = 568

Subtracting Across Zeros: Practice (continued)

Part 11 Remember? (continued)

98) 64 + **36** = 100

99) half of 86 = **43**

100) 2 halves = **1** whole

Part 12 Word problems Break once. Check by adding.

101) A school has 400 pencils. The kids use 156 of them. How many pencils are left?

Number sentence **400 − 156 = 244**

Answer **244** pencils

Draw or show your work

102) A book has 305 pages. Mia has read 128 pages. How many pages are left to read?

Number sentence **305 − 128 = 177**

Answer **177** pages

Draw or show your work

103) There were 610 people at a game. Then 245 people went home. How many people stayed?

Number sentence **610 − 245 = 365**

Answer **365** people

Draw or show your work

Subtracting Across Zeros: Practice (continued)

Part 12 Word problems (continued)

104) A jar holds 500 beads. 274 beads are red and the rest are blue. How many beads are blue?

Number sentence **500 − 274 = 226**

Answer **226** beads

Draw or show your work

105) Challenge: A game needs 1000 points. Kim has 455. How many more points does she need?

Number sentence **455 + 545 = 1000**

Answer **545** points

Draw or show your work

Check-In: Subtracting Across Zeros

Show what you know. No help this time.

Mastery: 8 of 9 (80%)

Part 1 Tens and ones

1) **903 = 90 tens + 3 ones**

903 = 89 tens + 13 ones

2) **409 = 40 tens + 9 ones**

409 = 39 tens + 19 ones

Part 2 Subtract Break once.

3)

	5	10	10
	~~6~~	~~1~~	~~0~~
−	4	7	3
	1	3	7

4)

	7	9	12
	~~8~~	~~0~~	~~2~~
−	2	1	3
	5	8	9

5)

	8	16	10
	~~9~~	~~7~~	~~0~~
−	6	8	1
	2	8	9

6)

	7	12	10
	~~8~~	~~3~~	~~0~~
−	7	3	3
		9	7

Part 3 Check by adding

7) **268 + 632 = 900**

8) **85 + 615 = 700**

9) **464 + 356 = 820**